

California Baptist University

Syllabus

CST360, Church History, 3 Units

Spring 2026, Section AE

COURSE DESCRIPTION

A survey of the development of the Christian church from the close of the New Testament period to the present time, with special attention to the origin of various denominations.

Prerequisites: None

ONLINE EDUCATION

In addition to on-ground courses, CBU recognizes the need for "online education" for students that need a flexible learning schedule. It offers university courses and degree programs both fully online and in "hybrid" format (partly online and partly on-ground).

Each "course week" begins on a Monday and ends on Sunday. Students should log in several times throughout the week to participate in online discussions and other activities. CBU recommends that students complete the various readings and assignments in the order in which they are presented, but the format does allow some flexibility for students to modify their approach or even to work ahead.

Active participation in every assignment and every online discussion is expected. Students should be careful of any assignments that have specific "opening" or "closing" times, and they should regularly consult the Course Schedule to ensure that they complete all work in a timely manner.

Students access all course materials via the *Blackboard* site, which includes minimum system requirements and orientation tutorials designed to equip class members for online study. These items can be found in the "technology help" folder located through the "student resources" link on the Blackboard course menu.

INSTRUCTOR CONTACT INFORMATION

1. Dr. John Gill
2. Phone: 951-343-3978
3. Email: jgill@calbaptist.edu
4. Office: PBLD 241 (Park/Business Building)
5. Office hours are in person or via WebEx/Zoom. Please schedule a meeting in advance in Calendly (https://calendly.com/jgill_cbu/spring-office-hours).

Monday: 9AM–11AM

Tuesday: 12:45PM–1:45PM

Wednesday: 9AM–11AM, 2:30PM–3PM

Friday: 9AM–11AM, 2:30PM–3PM

If the office hours above are outside of your available hours, please email the instructor with a few days and times that work for you.

REQUIRED TEXTS & RESOURCES

The CBU Campus Store provides a list of course textbooks and purchasing options on their official webpage: <https://bookstore.calbaptist.edu/textbooks>.

Online courses at CBU offer [Immediate Access](#) (IA), a digital course materials program that delivers required text materials in digital format, on “day-one” of the course, directly to students’ Blackboard account at a reduced cost. Students enrolled in participating courses will be charged the cost of the required text materials up front to their Student Account. This is an OPTIONAL program and students may OPT-OUT to receive a full refund. The OPT-OUT deadline is 14 days after the start of each session and students may OPT-OUT at any time within those 14 days. Visit the following link to learn more about how to Opt-Out: [Opt-Out instructions](#). Questions about Immediate Access? Email ImmediateAccess@calbaptist.edu or IA@calbaptist.edu

Note: Some publishers are unable to provide all textbooks digitally through IA. In situations where one or more texts are not available digitally through IA, students will not be charged by CBU for those texts and students must purchase them separately.

Below is a list of text(s) for this course:

1. Athanasius (2011). *On the Incarnation*. Yonkers, N.Y: St. Vladimir's Seminary Press. ISBN-13: 978-0881414271.
2. Calvin, J., Sadoletto, J., & Olin, J. C. (2000). *A Reformation debate*. Grand Rapids, MI: Baker Books. ISBN-13: 978-0801023903.
3. Noll, M. (2022). *Turning points: Decisive moments in the history of Christianity* (4th ed.). Grand Rapids: Baker Academic. ISBN-13: 978-1540964885.
4. Holy Bible. Any of the following translations of the Bible are acceptable: English Standard Version, New American Standard Version, New International Version, King James Version, New King James Version, New Revised Standard Version. While more contemporary versions or paraphrases might function well for re-phrasing more complex ideas stated in scripture, they do not serve well for the initial study of the text.

COURSE LEVEL OBJECTIVES

Course Level Objectives		SLO*	USO**
	Students will be able to:		
	Objective 1: Students will examine the purposes for studying the history of the Christian church.	3	APa, BR, GM
	Objective 2: Students will examine the major events, figures, beliefs, and practices in the history of the Christian church.	3	APa, BR, GM
	Objective 3: Students will examine the origins, major events, figures, beliefs, and practices of various Christian denominations and traditions.	3	APa, BR, GM

*Student Learning Outcomes; **University Student Outcomes – Academically Prepared: Critical Thinking for Literacy (APa); Academically Prepared: Math, Science, Tech. (APb); Biblically Rooted (BR); Globally Minded (GM); Equipped to Serve: Profession, Workplace (ESa); Equipped to Serve: Social Ethics, Community Involvement (ESb)

ASSIGNMENTS OVERVIEW

Getting to Know You Discussion Board: Students will introduce themselves to their peers and instructor.

Lectures: Lectures will be given each week. Students will attend in-person lectures (hybrid course) or watch recorded lectures in Blackboard (online course) (CLOs 1-3).

Readings: Reading Assignments will be assigned for each week. There are two types of reading assigned in this course. Secondary sources — Secondary sources are works that organize and present information (e.g. events, people, issues, etc.) that originally conveyed in another time and/or place. For this course, Noll's Turning Points is a secondary source. Primary sources — Primary sources are created during the time/era that is being considered. They are what secondary sources use as evidence and sources. In this course, primary sources include the books by Athanasius and Calvin (CLOs 1-3).

Quizzes: Quizzes will be given each week in Blackboard. The 60-minute quizzes will cover the assigned reading in Noll and class lectures, typically will be objective in type (multiple choice, multiple answer, true or false), and must be completed by day 7 of each week they are assigned. The quizzes are closed book, closed notes (CLOs 2-3).

Athanasius, Calvin Discussions: Discussion boards will be assigned according to the course schedule in Blackboard. These discussion boards will be based on the books by Athanasius and Calvin (except for the discussion board in week 1). There will be two discussion forums for both authors.

The assignment consists of two parts:

- a) Original response — Your initial discussion board post. You will not be able to access your peers' posts until you post yours, which is by design. Everyone comes to the discussion with their original response "in hand." Read the assigned primary source for the week. Each week's discussion board will include specific instructions. Please read them carefully before constructing your original response. This original response should be a minimum of 250 words, focusing on clarity and pertinent content rather than flowery language and space fillers. This will be due by Day 5 of the week (Friday).*
- b) Peer responses — This is an opportunity to interact with what your peers had to say about the primary sources. Read at least five original discussion board entries written by your peers. You will write peer responses to two of your peers' original discussion board entries (80 words minimum each). This is about interacting with your peers, which can include reflection, agreeing, disagreeing, and asking responsive

questions of what your peers wrote. Please be thoughtful, detailed, clear, and respectful. They are your peers, not your opponents. This will be due by Day 7 of the week (Sunday).**

*Note the earlier date for the first part of this assignment. A late submission affects your peers, so please be punctual. ** I will be grading one original response and two comments for each student (CLOs 2-3).

Critical Assignment Preliminary Report: This assignment is designed to be preparation for the critical assignment. It will include the following (CLOs 1-3):

1. Selection of text (either the Athanasius text or Calvin text)
2. Thesis statement of the selected text
3. Paper outline (see required sections for the paper in Week 8 instructions)
4. Annotated bibliography with at least two academic sources (journal articles or books) other than the course textbooks and Bible. Students are required to use the CBU Library for these sources (digital or print sources). Annotations should be 50–100 words and focus on summary (not evaluation).

Critical Assignment: Primary source research paper on either Calvin or Athanasius. The paper will be 5.5 pages minimum (not counting title page and bibliography). The Critical Assignment will consist of the following:

1. Title page
2. Introduction — This should include a brief description of the author's life, and the book's thesis. (half page minimum)
3. Author's argument — This section should demonstrate how the author argues his thesis in detail. This is not a section for personal reflection. (3 pages minimum)
4. Personal Reflection — The student will evaluate how the thesis and argument are especially relevant to each of the following: (a) one's personal spirituality/piety (two points minimum), (b) the Christian Church/community of faith (two points minimum). (The personal reflection section must be 2 pages minimum)
5. Bibliography — include at least three academic sources besides the assigned primary source and course textbook. Sources must be sufficiently academic and relevant to the topic(s) being analyzed in the paper (Wikipedia, blogs, etc. should not be end sources for this assignment).

Formatting and Mechanics — Paper assessment will also take the following into account: The paper is formatted properly (12-point font, Times New Roman font, double-spaced, 1-inch margins, submitted as .doc or .pdf file). The student uses correct grammar, spelling and punctuation. Clarity and organization are important for successfully conveying your ideas to the reader (me) (CLOs 1-3).

* All work submitted for this course must be your own work, must have been developed specifically for this course, and may not have been submitted for evaluation or assessment in any other course. The Critical Assignment will be used to verify that the essential knowledge, skills, and abilities for the course have been achieved.

ASSESSMENT POLICIES

Course Evaluation Plan

An assessment instrument (checklist, rubric, etc.) will accompany each major graded assignment. See the course website for specific assignment criteria and the accompanying grading instruments.

Points Distribution

Graded assignments will be weighted as follows:

Graded Assignments	Points Possible
Getting to Know You Discussion Board	50
Quizzes	6 x 30, 7th 60 (240)
Athanasius, Calvin Discussions	400 (4 x 100 each)
Critical Assignment Preliminary Report	60
Critical Assignment	250
Total Points:	1000

Final Grades

The following scale will be used when calculating final grades:

A	93%-100%	B-	80%-82%	D+	67%-69%
A-	90%-92%	C+	77%-79%	D	63%-66%
B+	87%-89%	C	73%-76%	D-	60%-62%
B	83%-86%	C-	70%-72%	F	<60%

Checking Grades

Be sure to check your grades often via the “My Grades” section in Blackboard.

COURSE SCHEDULE

This online course begins on a Monday. Accordingly, the course week extends from Monday through Sunday. Unless stated otherwise, graded assignments are due on the last day of the course week (Sunday).

Week	Learning Activities	Assignments Due
Week 1 1/12–18		
	Lecture 1	
	Noll, Introduction (pp xv–xxv) and Chapter 1 (pp1–26); Athanasius, Preface (pp9–15), Introduction (pp17–34)	
	Getting to Know You Discussion Board	Week 1, Day 7
	Quiz 1	Week 1, Day 7
Week 2 1/19–25		
	Lecture 2	
	Noll, ch2–3 (pp27–64); Athanasius, Introduction (pp34–45), <i>On the Incarnation</i> (pp49–70, sections 1–19)	
	Athanasius Discussion Board 1	Week 2, Day 5 and 7
	Quiz 2	Week 2, Day 7
Week 3 1/26–2/1		
	Lecture 3	
	Noll, ch4–5 (pp65–106); Athanasius, <i>On the Incarnation</i> (pp70–110, sections 20–57)	
	Athanasius Discussion Board 2	Week 3, Day 5 and 7
	Quiz 3	Week 3, Day 7
Week 4		

2/2-8		
	Lecture 4	
	Noll, ch6-7 (pp107-151); Calvin, Preface (p6), Introduction (pp7-27)	
	Calvin Discussion Board 1	Week 4, Day 5 and 7
	Quiz 4	Week 4, Day 7
Week 5 2/9-15		
	Lecture 5	
	Noll, ch8-9 (pp152-198); Calvin, <i>Calvin's Reply to Sadoletto</i> (pp49-94)	
	Discussion Board 2	Week 5, Day 5 and 7
	Quiz 5	Week 5, Day 7
Week 6 2/16-22		
	Lecture 6	
	Noll, ch10-11 (pp199-245)	
	Quiz 6	
	Research for Critical Assignment (Preliminary Report)	Week 6, Day 7
Week 7 2/23-3/1		
	Lecture 7	
	Noll, ch12 (pp246-270)	
	Noll, ch13 and Afterward (pp271-312)	
	Quiz 7	Week 7, Day 7
Week 8 3/2-8		
	Critical Assignment	Week 8, Day 4
	(Optional) Billy Graham Sermon	

* The course schedule, located in the syllabus, always dictates the due date for a particular activity or assignment.

EXPECTATIONS

Professionalism

All written work must be of professional quality and must be keyed using a computer. Handwritten work will not be accepted. In addition, work that has excessive or distracting grammatical, mechanical, or typographical errors will be graded accordingly. All written assignments should be formatted according to the style guide that is appropriate to the discipline (e.g., APA, MLA, Chicago, etc.).

As a professional, you are expected to collaborate with your colleagues during in-class activities or out-of-class group projects, and to respect one another with exemplary listening skills during all interactions, presentations, and class discussions. This also requires supporting your classmates with positive body language and appropriate verbal communication.

Regular Effective Contact

Students and instructors will, at a minimum, adhere to the following:

- LancerMail should be used for all email communication and checked on a daily basis.
- Timely feedback for communication is 24 hours* and may be handled by email, phone, or in person.
- Timely feedback for assessed work is 72 hours* for minor assignments (section tests, smaller papers/projects) and 1 week* for major assignments (midterm, final, major project/paper).

* After submission deadline and/or excluding weekends

Late Assignments

CBU encourages all course instructors to provide students with their individual late policies for each course section. Late policies are strictly adhered to unless deviation is approved by the course instructor prior to due date or unless verifiable, extreme, and unforeseen circumstances prevail. Please find your instructor's late policy for this course below.

Due to the accelerated schedule, late work will not be accepted in this class unless due to extenuating circumstances (as approved by the professor). The syllabus course schedule conveys when assignments are due, which determines whether an assignment is late or not. In the case of extenuating circumstances, it is the student's responsibility to contact the instructor as soon as possible to discuss the matter.

*Late work will not be accepted after the course end date.

Netiquette

"Netiquette" can be described as a set of guidelines that govern the behavior of Internet users. These guidelines are a collection of best practices that promote professionalism, respect, safety and good digital citizenship.

A summary of Netiquette guidelines has been created based on published sources such as Virginia Shea's online book, Netiquette (2004). The summary can be accessed via the following Web link: [Link to Netiquette Guidelines](#)

All students are expected to follow Netiquette guidelines when communicating electronically with classmates and instructors.

Academic Honesty

All violations of the Honor Code must be reported to the Student Services Office. Violations include, but are not limited to: direct plagiarism (the misrepresentation of material as a student's own effort), self-plagiarism (e.g. submitting one's own work previously submitted for another course), or submitting materials obtained from other students, publications, or the internet as a student's own work.

A first incident of violation of the Honor Code is handled at the discretion of the professor, in consultation with Academic

Administration. Upon a second incident, judicial sanctions for an offense are handled on a case-by-case basis depending on the seriousness of the violation, prior violations, and other factors. Judicial sanctions may include, but are not limited to, loss of a letter grade, failure of the respective assignment/examination, failure in the course in which the offense occurred, suspension, and/or expulsion from the University. A detailed discussion of academic dishonesty appears in the CBU Student Handbook.

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

At CBU, we want students to develop the wisdom to know when and how to use generative AI tools as part of their learning. Some assignments and activities are designed to measure your own original thinking and reflections, and in those cases, using AI may not be appropriate or permitted. At other times, limited and thoughtful use of AI tools may support your learning, provided it is allowed by your instructor. When use is permitted, you are expected to use AI transparently and acknowledge its role in your work. Ultimately, using good judgment by discerning when independent thinking is required and when responsible AI assistance can be helpful is an essential part of your academic responsibility.

AI Course Policy — While AI tools such as ChatGPT can be useful in some settings, they are not permitted for coursework in this class.

The purpose of our assignments is to help you develop your own skills in reading, critical thinking, research, and writing. Relying on AI to generate ideas or text short-circuits that learning process. You may, however, use standard academic aids such as Grammarly (for spelling/grammar/style); Zotero, EndNote, or similar tools (for organizing and formatting citations); and Word processors' built-in functions (spell check, outlining, etc.). All other forms of AI use, including brainstorming, drafting, paraphrasing, or generating examples, are prohibited. If you have questions about what counts as acceptable support, please ask me before submitting your work.

Students with Disabilities

Students who have a documented disability and wish to arrange the appropriate accommodation must contact the CBU Office of Disability Services at disabilityservices@calbaptist.edu.